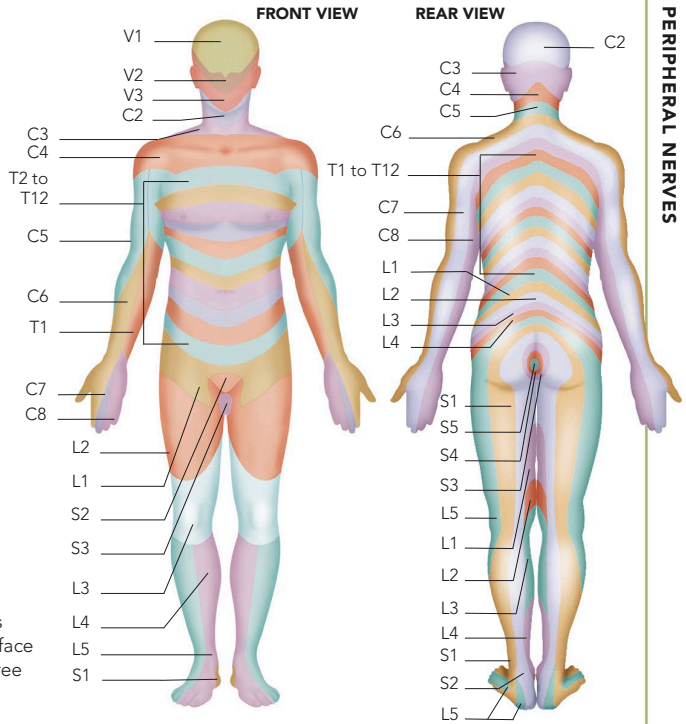


## DERMATOMES

A dermatome is a region or zone of skin supplied by the dorsal (rear, sensory) nerve roots of one pair of spinal nerves. The nerve branches carry sensory information about touch, pressure, heat, cold, and pain from the skin microensors within the zone, along the sensory fibres of the spinal nerve, to the nerve root and then into the spinal cord. A "skin map" delineates these zones, or dermatomes. In real life, the distribution of nerve roots, and so of sensations, overlaps slightly.

### DERMATOME MAP

Spinal nerve C1 has no sensory fibres from the skin, and so is omitted; the face and forehead send signals via the three branches of the trigeminal cranial (V) nerve, coded here as V1–V3.



## SPINAL REFLEXES

A spinal reflex is a rapid, involuntary response to a stimulus. A circuit of sensory nerve fibres feeds information to the spinal cord and then connects to motor nerve fibres. The resulting instructions for movement go out directly from the cord to the relevant muscles.

